Does this reply follow our return policy?

Return Policy

A:
refund eligible



B:
replacement eligible



C:
not eligible



D:
order number needed



What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A small online shop receives return questions. A broad AI prompt may sound friendly but give an incorrect answer. Students need a way to improve an answer and check it against the policy.

TARGET

Learning goal

Diagnose one output weakness, change one prompt instruction, and compare the result against the same source policy.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Fictional shop policy

- Unopened item with receipt returned within 14 days of delivery: refund eligible. Item reported damaged within 7 days: replacement eligible. Opened, undamaged item: not eligible for a standard refund. If receipt or a required detail is missing, ask for the order number and do not promise an exception.

CASE MATERIAL

Customer messages

- A: unopened, receipt available, arrived 10 days ago. B: arrived cracked yesterday, customer can send a photo. C: opened, changed mind, arrived 6 days ago. D: refund requested, receipt missing.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Treat the policy as the source of truth

- The AI should classify a request using the shop's stated rules, not a general idea of what seems fair. An unopened item with a receipt and a return within 14 days can qualify for a refund. An item reported damaged within 7 days can qualify for a replacement. Those are different outcomes. If a required detail is missing, ask for it instead of promising an exception.

LEARN

Diagnose the answer before changing the prompt

- A reply can sound warm and still be wrong. Check whether it names the correct outcome, gives a reason from the policy, and avoids unsupported promises. Compare the output with cases A-D: A is refund eligible, B is replacement eligible, C is not eligible for a standard refund, and D needs an order number. Write down the exact error before editing anything.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Change one instruction and rerun the same cases

- Keep the policy and customer messages fixed. Change one instruction, such as requiring a policy-based label or a next step when information is missing. Compare the original and revised answers against the same cases. A change log records the weakness, the one prompt change, and whether accuracy improved. Changing many instructions at once makes it hard to tell what helped.

APPLY

Three-step method

- Run a short prompt; identify one visible weakness; change one instruction and compare both outputs against the policy.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Reply to these customers.

Message AI...

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Make every customer happy and approve each request.

Message AI...

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Use only the policy and customer messages below.
For each case, label the result Eligible, Not eligible under the stated policy,
or Information needed. Give one policy reason. Do not invent exceptions.

Message AI...

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Draft a separate reply for each customer using only the policy.
Start with the result, give one brief reason, and state the next step.
If information is missing, ask for it without promising approval.
Keep each reply under 50 words.

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Paste the policy and cases A-D into AI. Compare Poor Prompt 1 with Improved Prompt 1. Check the answer: A is refund eligible; B is replacement eligible; C is not eligible under the stated policy; D needs the order number and is not yet approved. Record one weakness, the prompt change, and the observed improvement.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Add Case E: unopened, arrived 10 days ago, receipt missing, order number available. Revise only what is needed so the AI asks the shop to verify the order rather than promising a refund.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W6_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Describe the online shop's return questions and why a friendly but wrong reply is a problem.
- Method: Copy the original prompt and each revised prompt. Note the one instruction you changed each time.
- Results: Include the three-row prompt change log (weakness, prompt change, result) and the AI's labels for cases A-D, checked against the policy.
- Conclusion: Include the accurate reply for Case E, and explain which single change improved accuracy the most.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- The response follows the policy for A-D and requests verification for E without inventing an exception.